



Designing an ordering app for Australia's fastest growing food franchise

It all started when Roll'd CEO Bao Hoang's family escaped Vietnam by boat with nothing besides his family's traditional recipes. Fast forward a few years and 72 stores later, the Vietnamese-inspired street food phenomenon is now the fastest-growing Australian restaurant chain.

Challenges

Minimize wait time in popular stores

Roll'd were experiencing POS bottlenecks during busy lunch hours which resulted in long lines. This frustrated in-store patrons and deterred prospective Roll'd customers.

Design the MVP experience in 3 weeks

I had three weeks to work with product teams, engineers and executives to design an app experience for 72 Roll'd stores.

Goals

What does success look like?

- Proving product market fit for app/loyalty benefits
- Improve order throughput at busy store peak times

My involvement

I worked as the lead designer to validate/build prototypes and create production-ready assets. I collaborated with Roll'd product owners, the marketing team and an external development team.

Keeping the approach lean



Research

- Visit a Roll'd store during peak-time
- Assess the in-store ordering experience
- Find out if customers care about an app

Design Sprint

- Explore MVP solutions and opportunities
- Build stakeholder alignment on solutions
- Prototype and user test

Refine

- Refine the prototype as needed
- Define the MVP & initial user stories
- Visual and interaction design

To understand the challenges customers faced during the ordering process, I created surveys, service blueprint maps and proto-personas



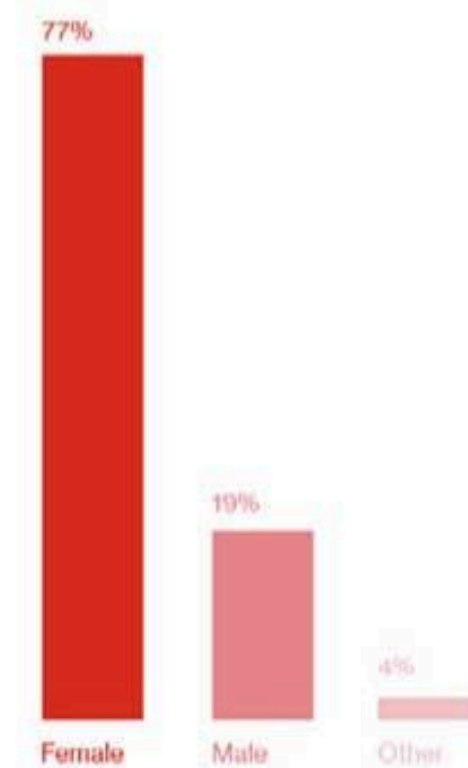
Julie Walker
Weekly customer

Working Mum, 38 years old
Lives in Melbourne, household income: 200k / yr

- Works full time in a corporate environment
- Buys Rolld 2 times every week
- Has little time to herself outside of managing three kids
- Highly organised and efficient
- Uses technology on a daily basis at work

Needs & Goals

- Eating conveniently to accommodate a busy work schedule
- Doesn't want to feel guilty about eating out
- To feel cultured for exploring vietnamese cuisine
- Take her food back to her desk so she can eat and work
- Customise her order to reduce calorie intake

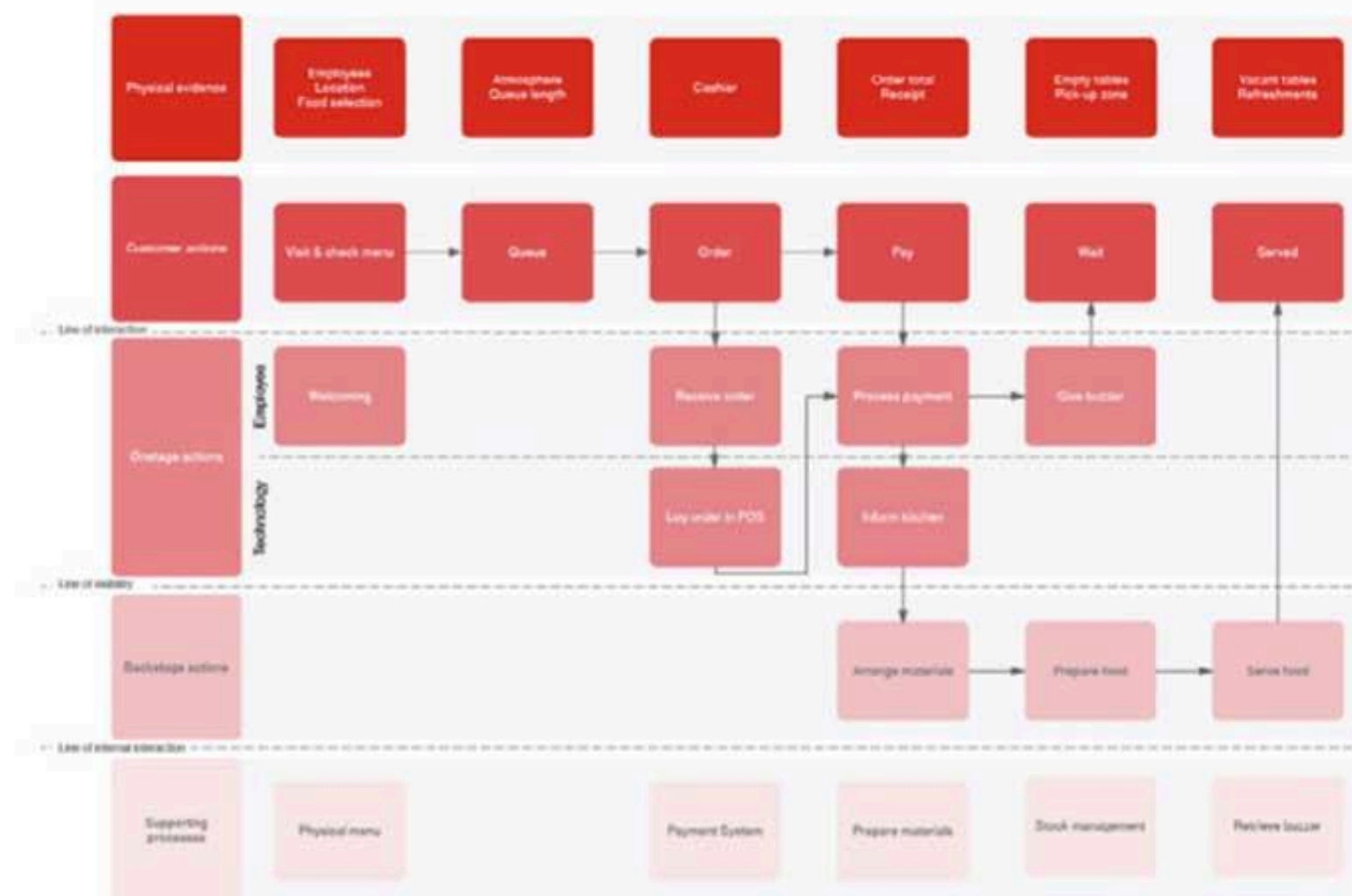


Feature expectations

Discount offers	4.3
Exclusive app offers	3.4
Order notifications	3.1
Loyalty rewards	2.3

Perception of Roll'd

- Convenient
- Consistent
- Great customer service
- High food quality
- Healthy



Key insights

While waiting to pick up orders, 83% of customers actively used their phone during the downtime

Foreign naming conventions prevented the non-Vietnamese audiences from trying out different food

Order status and pickup zones weren't obvious, which caused unnecessary questions for staff

Design principles

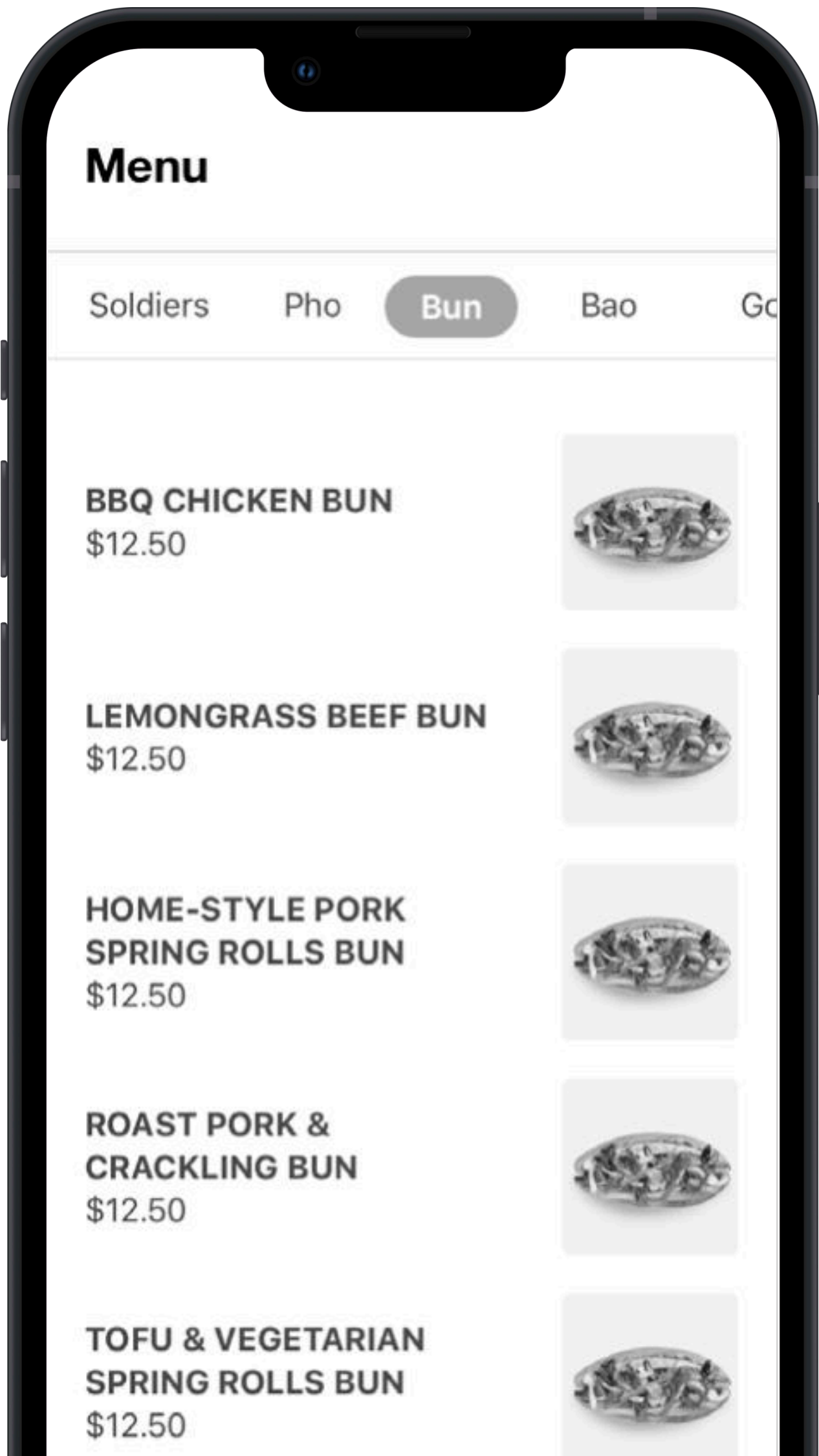
- Design for speed
- Improve food discovery
- Self-guided ordering experience

Early home page iterations (mid-fi)

First, we worked with stakeholders to establish the design direction for the home page (menu), which was critical to the experience, but also the most controversial screen to build alignment on

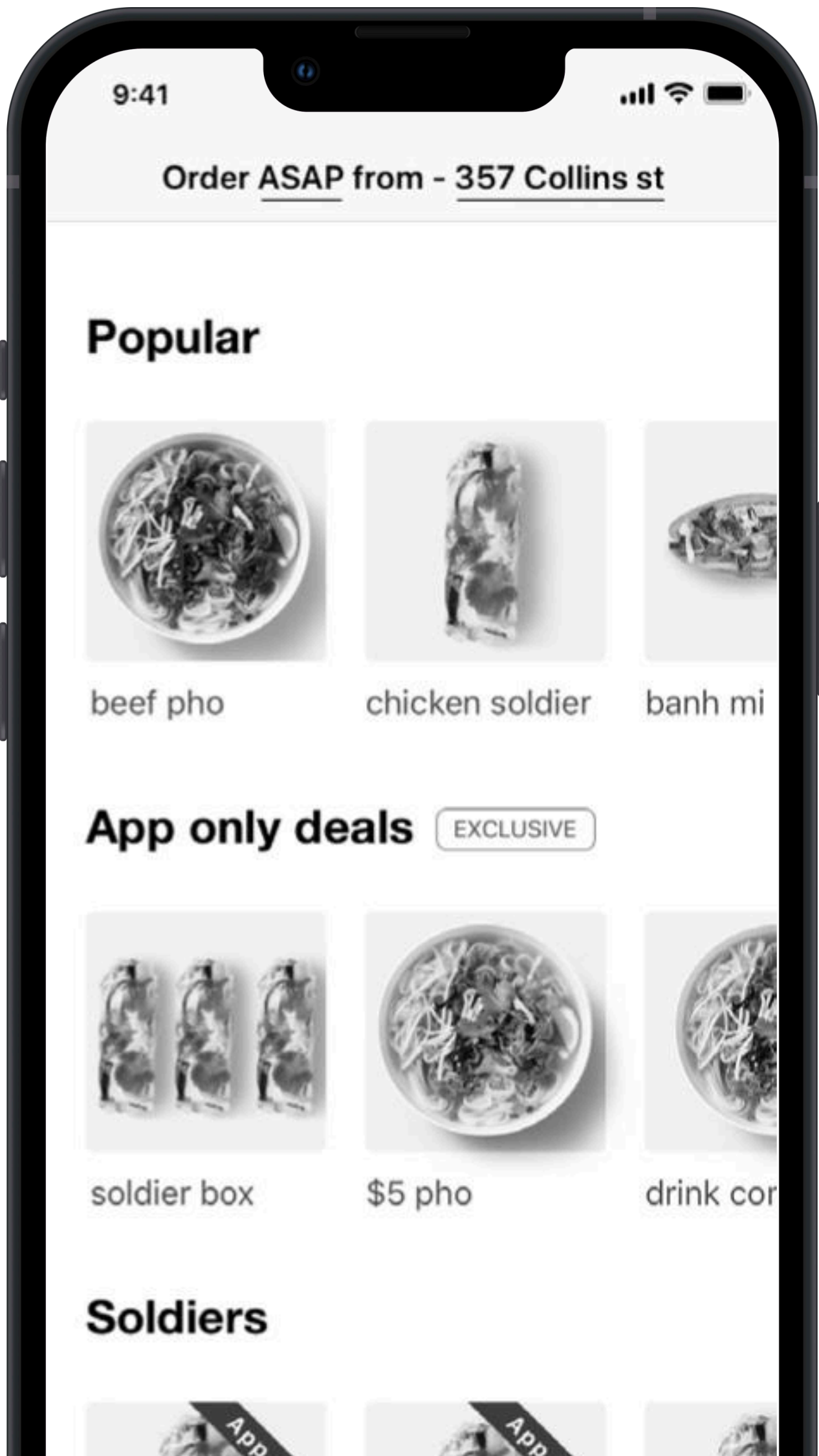
First iteration

In this version, I explored designing the menu as a list pattern to condense more menu items within the initial viewport.



Second iteration

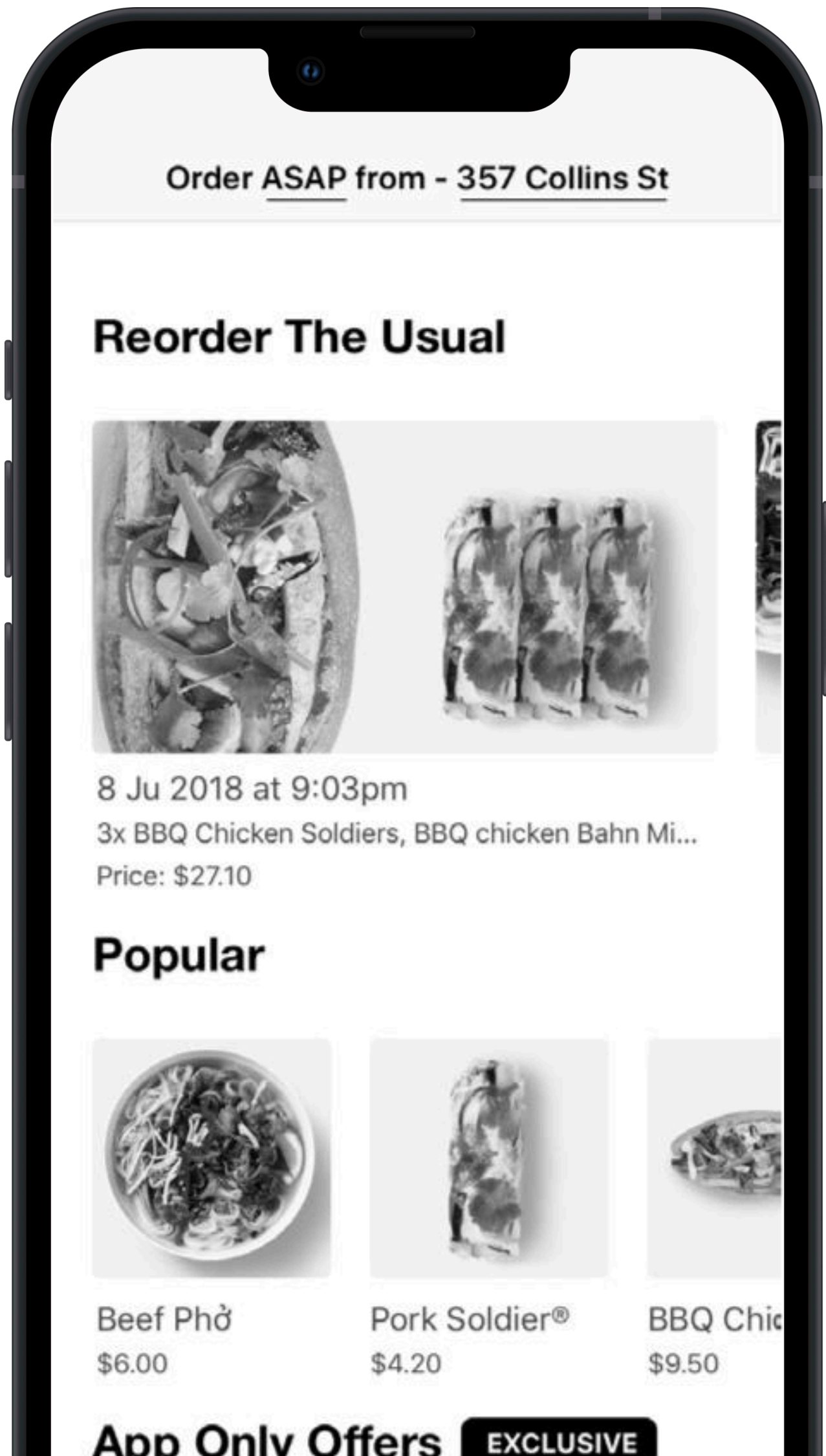
Surveys had shown that 76% of sales came from a handful of menu items - because of this, I started exploring clear and contextual categories, making it easier for users to move through the ordering process without drilling down into the larger menu.



Third iteration

Shipped

User testing had revealed that most customers consistently reordered the same thing - because of this, I updated the UX to allow users to easily reorder meals in 2 taps.

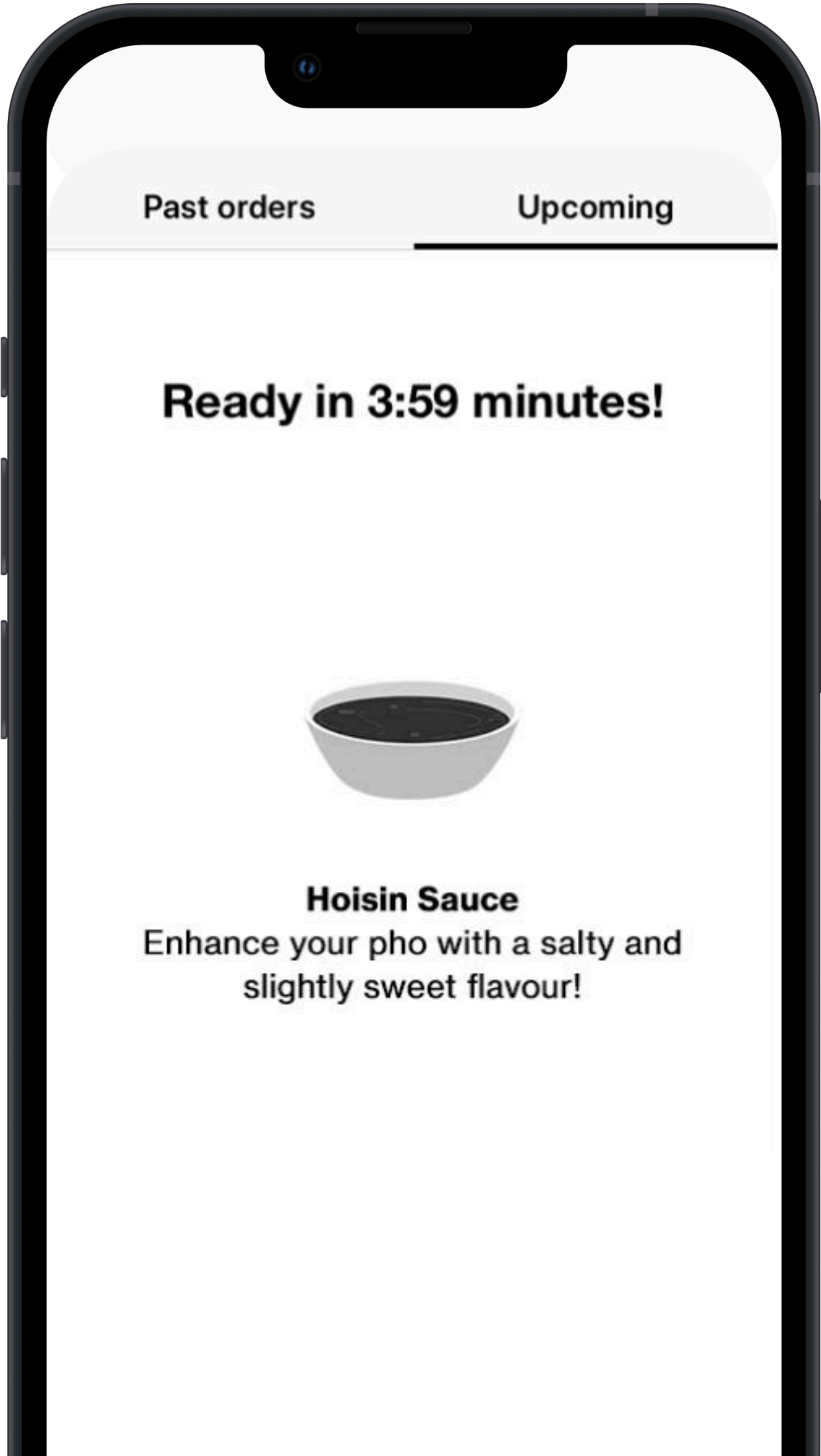


How might we make waiting for orders engaging?

While observing Roll'd's restaurants, I noticed that most of the customers waiting for their orders were on their phones - using this insight, I worked with product owners, engineers and marketers to conceptualize ideas that capitalized on this downtime.

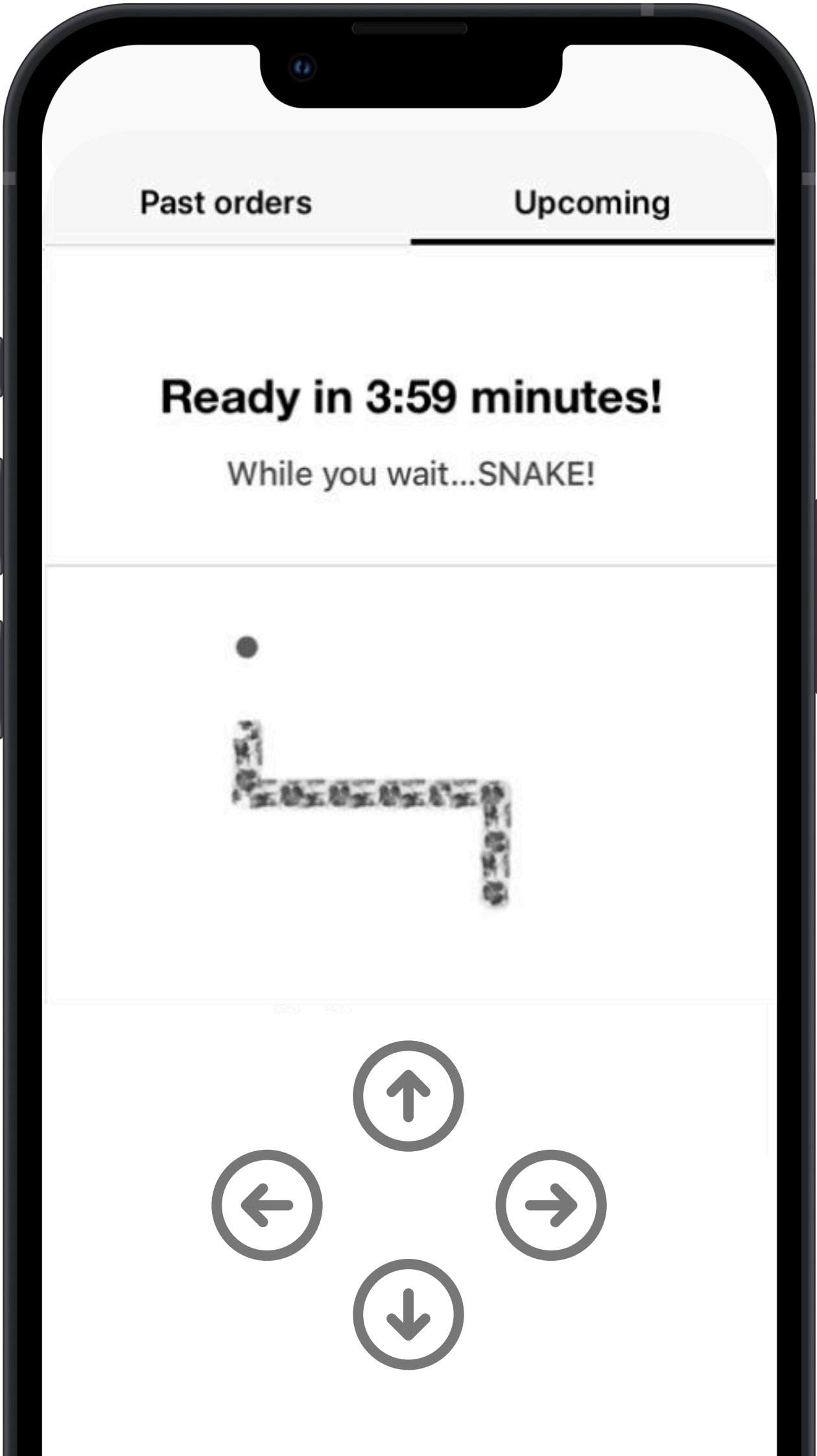
Concept 1

To solve customer confusion around foreign naming conventions, I explored surfacing educational content to encourage food discovery and last-minute purchases.



Concept 2

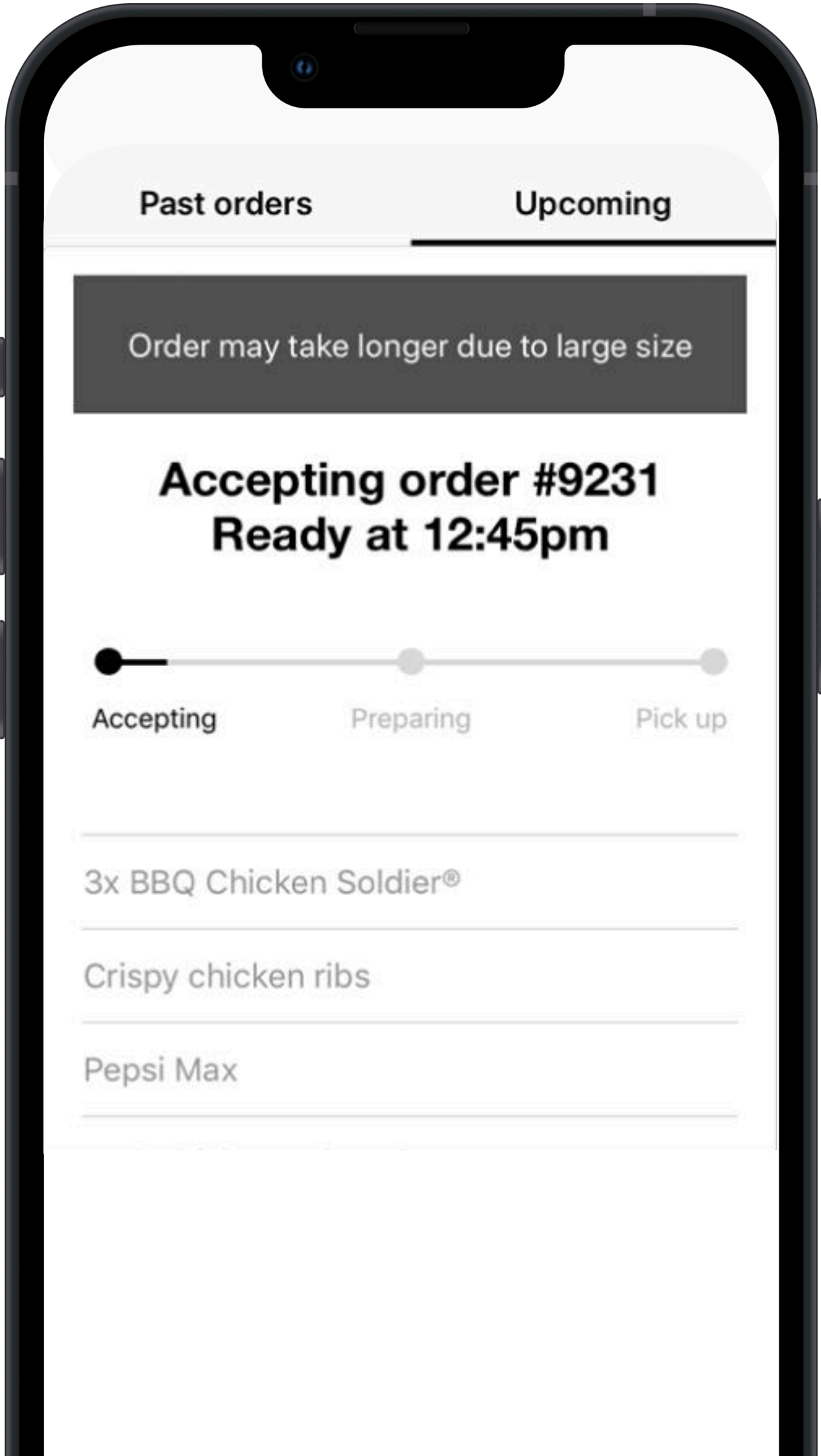
Leveraging gamification elements, I envisioned the customers playing Vietnamese roll snake against other people in the queue to make earning loyalty points more engaging.



Concept 3

Shipped

Inspired by the endowed progress effect, I designed this concept to provide bold, rich, relevant progress at different stages of the order.

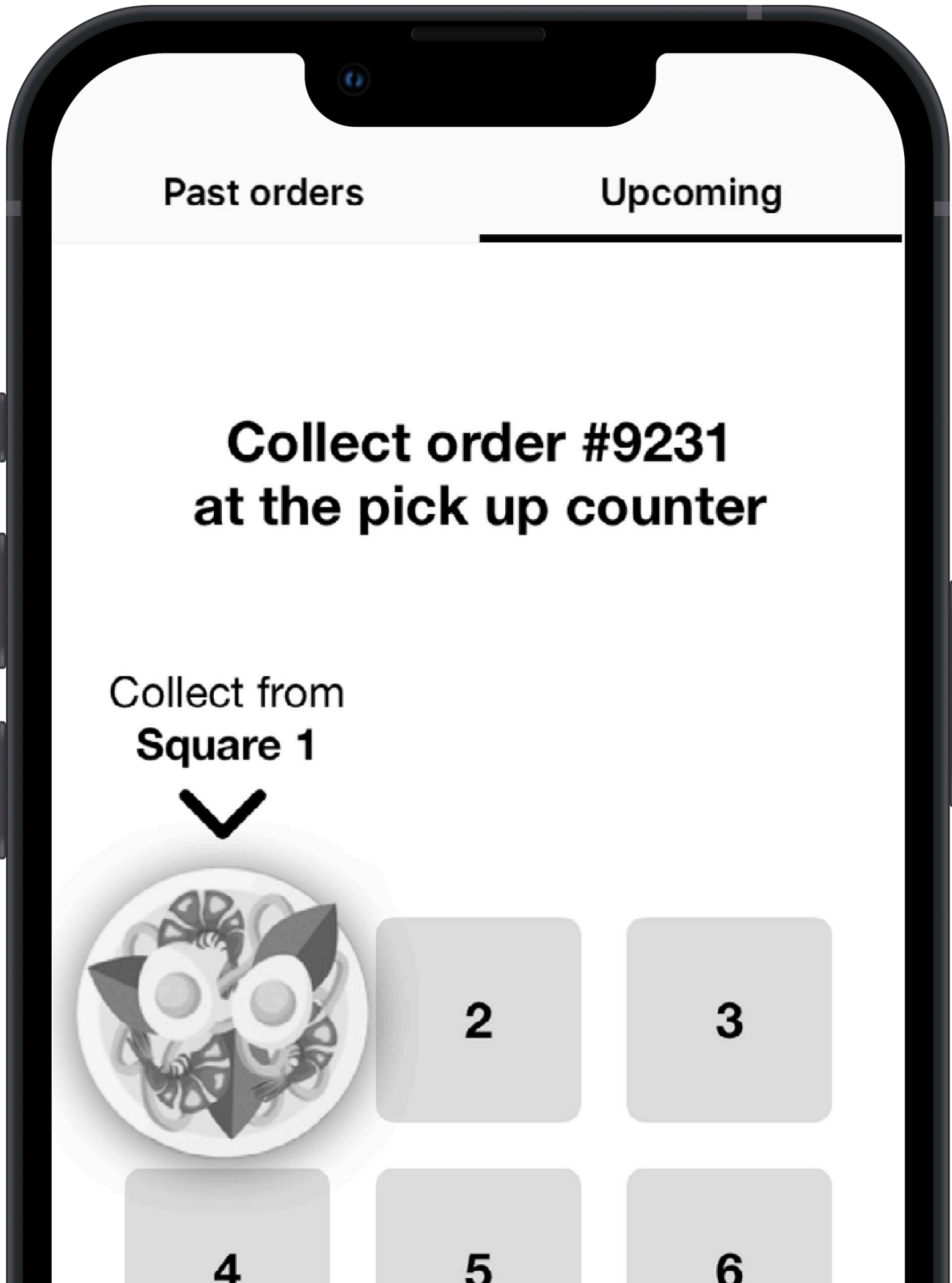


Order pickup, without the confusion

Field visits revealed that the order pickup process was confusing. Pickup zones weren't clearly marked, which resulted in customers interrupting staff to find out if their order was ready.

Concept 1

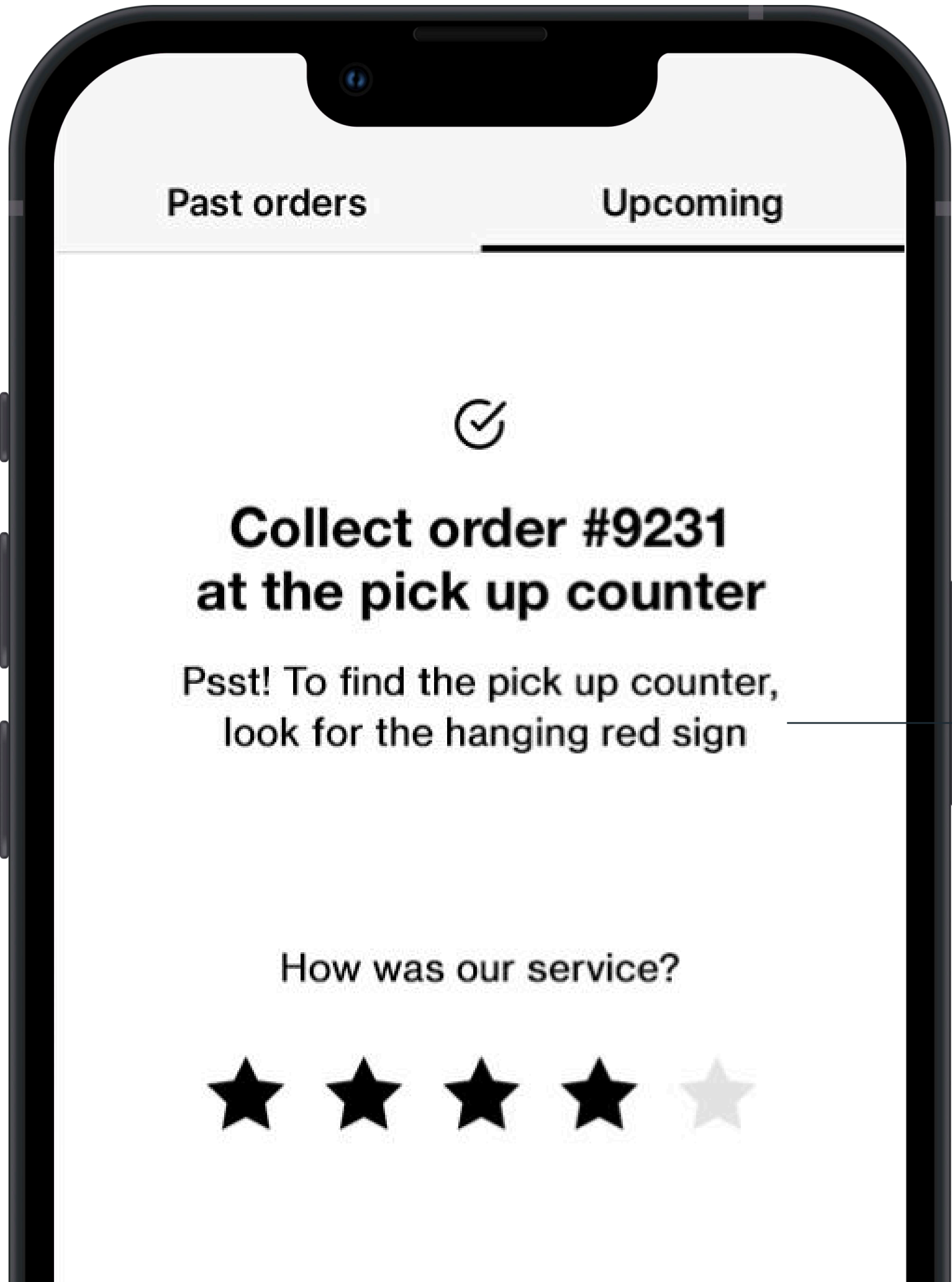
I worked with product owners and restaurant staff on an “order pickup grid” concept. This idea explored having a numbered, self-explanatory placemat at the stores pick up counter - the app correlated with this physical system, with the intention of making pick ups completely self-guided.



Concept 2

Shipped

The team decided to move forward with this simpler version in order to ship the MVP in time. This concept relied on clear phrasing, bold typography and in-store signage to quickly get the customer from app to the stores pickup counter.



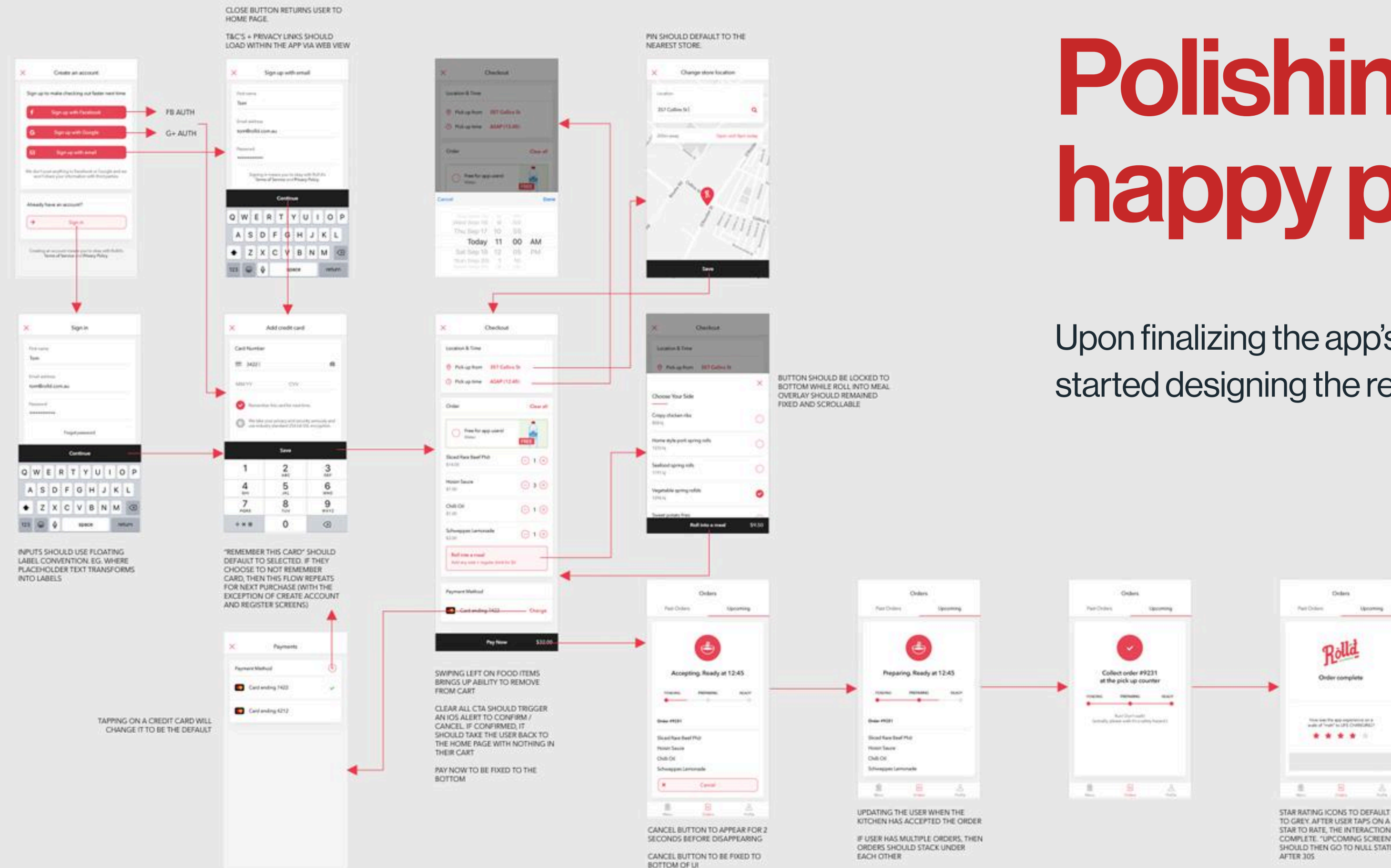
Place description

To find the pickup counter look for the hanging red sign

Anchor location

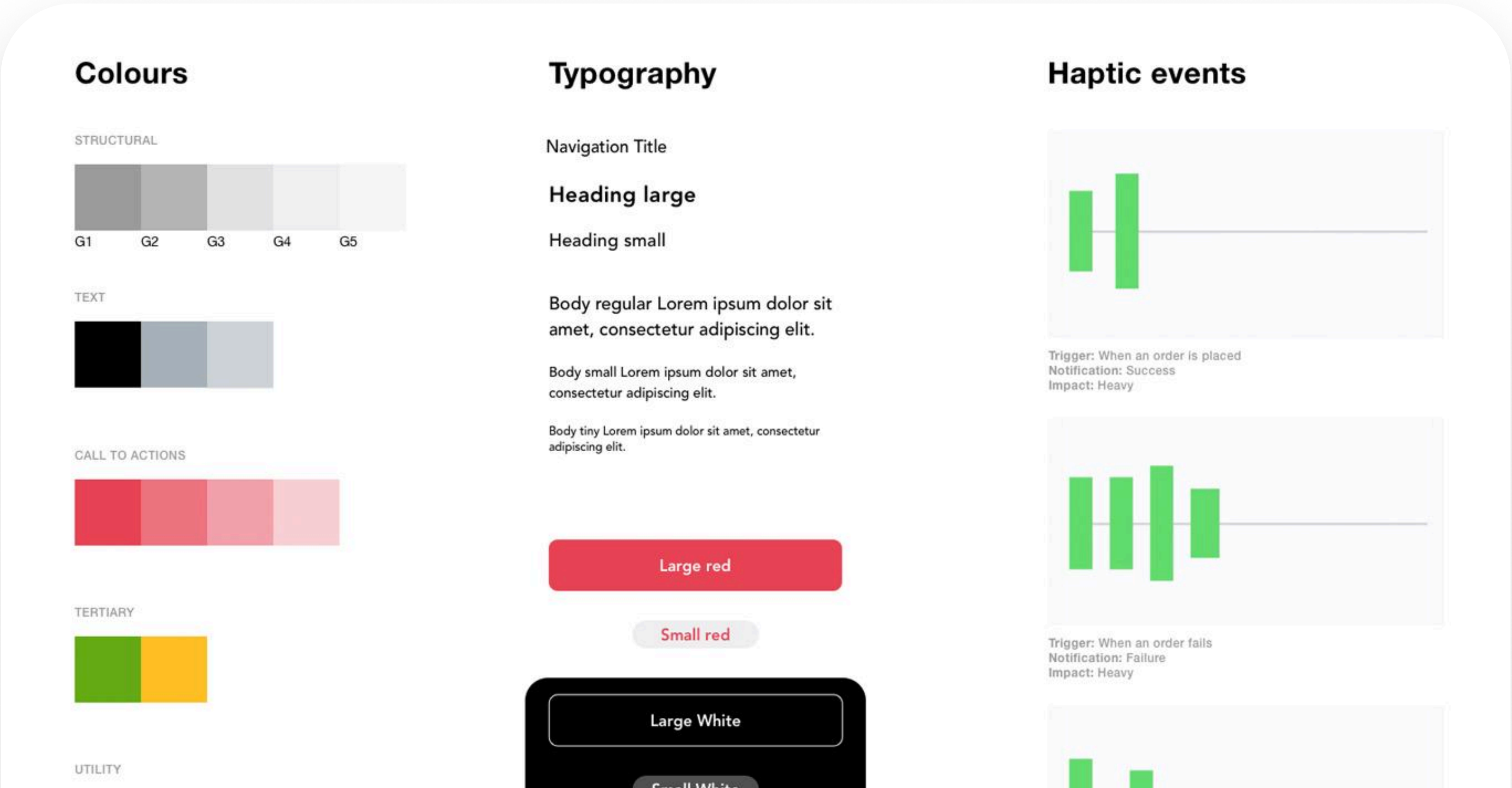
Polishing the happy path

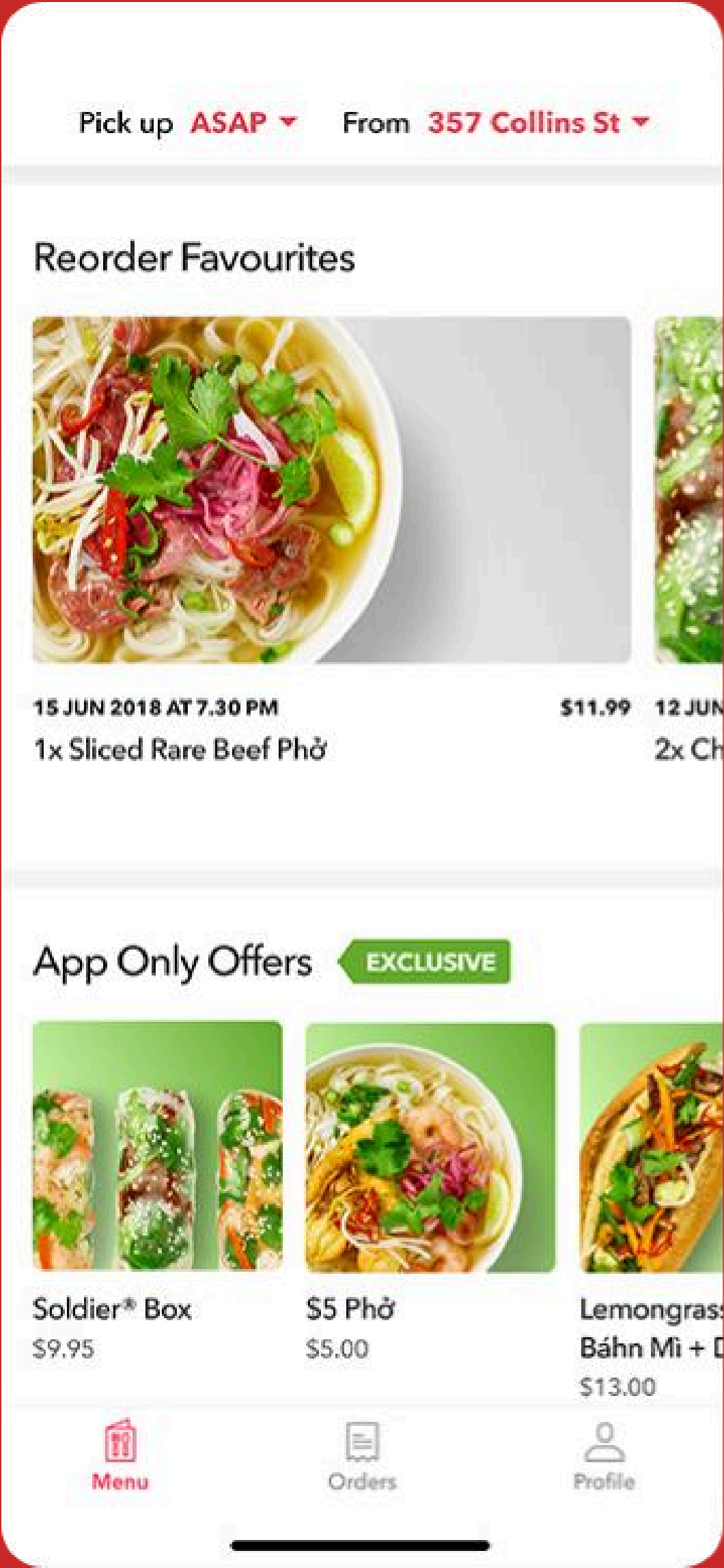
Upon finalizing the app's happy path direction, I started designing the remaining page flows



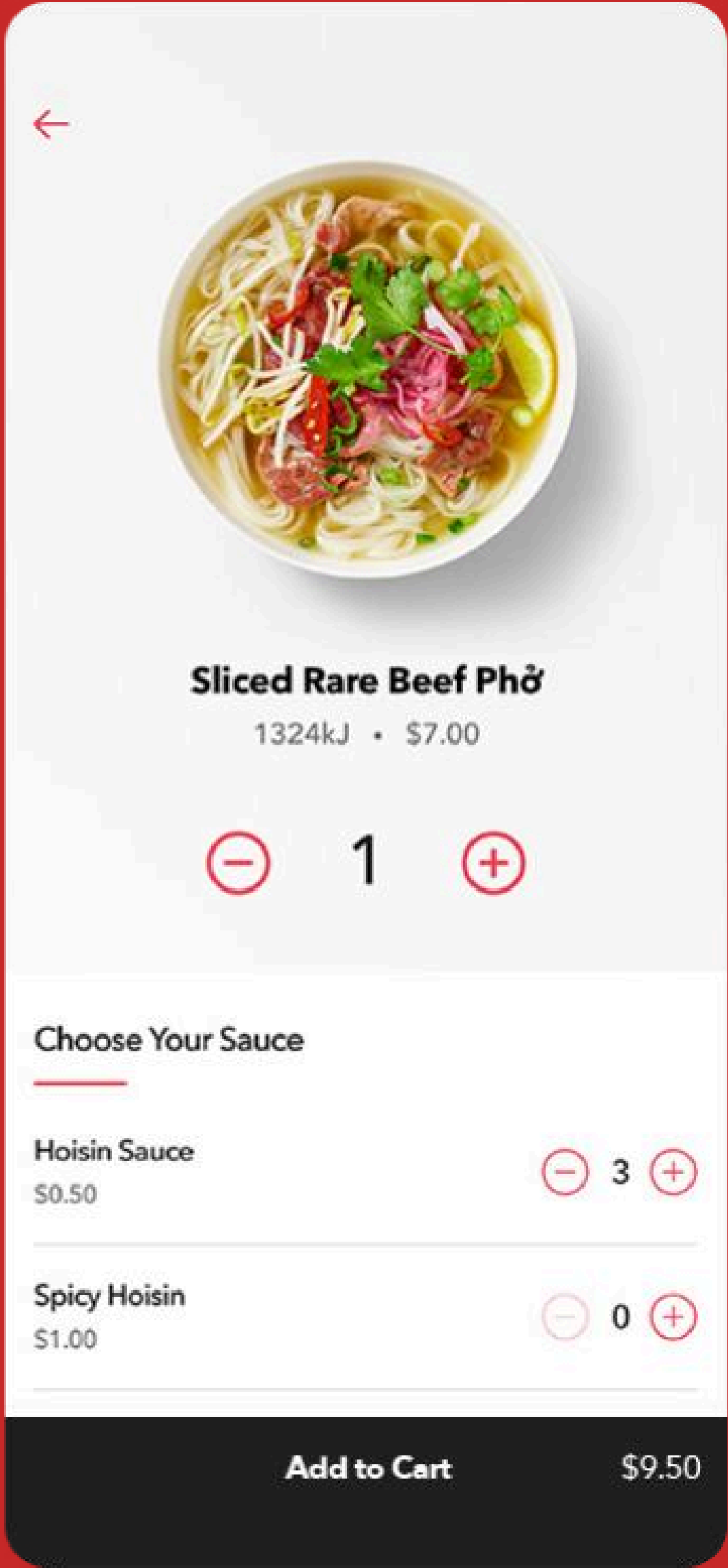
Creating the design system

Upon finalizing the app's core experience, I created a lightweight design system for designers and developers alike, ensuring consistency, design pattern reusability, accessibility, and faster development.

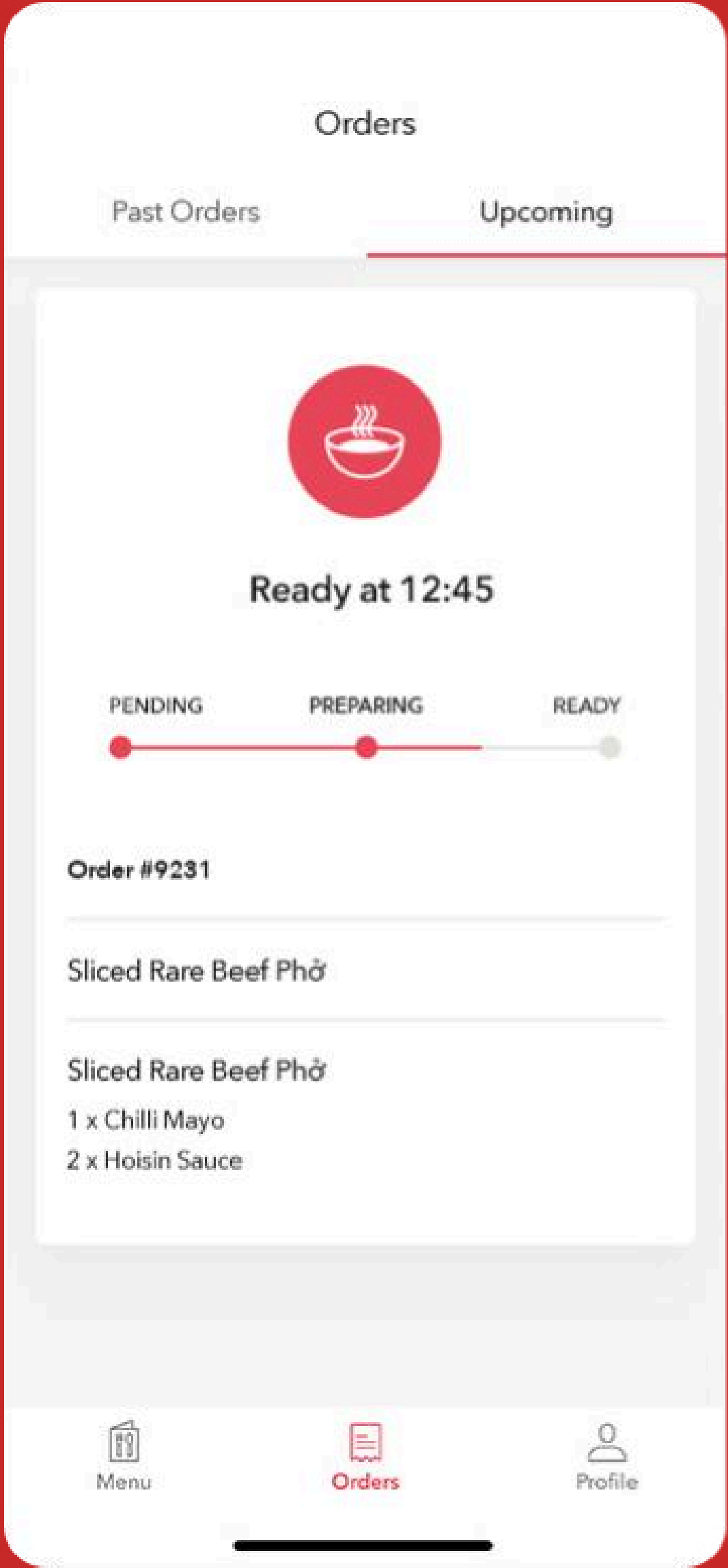




The clean, simple visual design prioritized stunning, bespoke food photography to contrast boldly with subtle supporting UI elements.



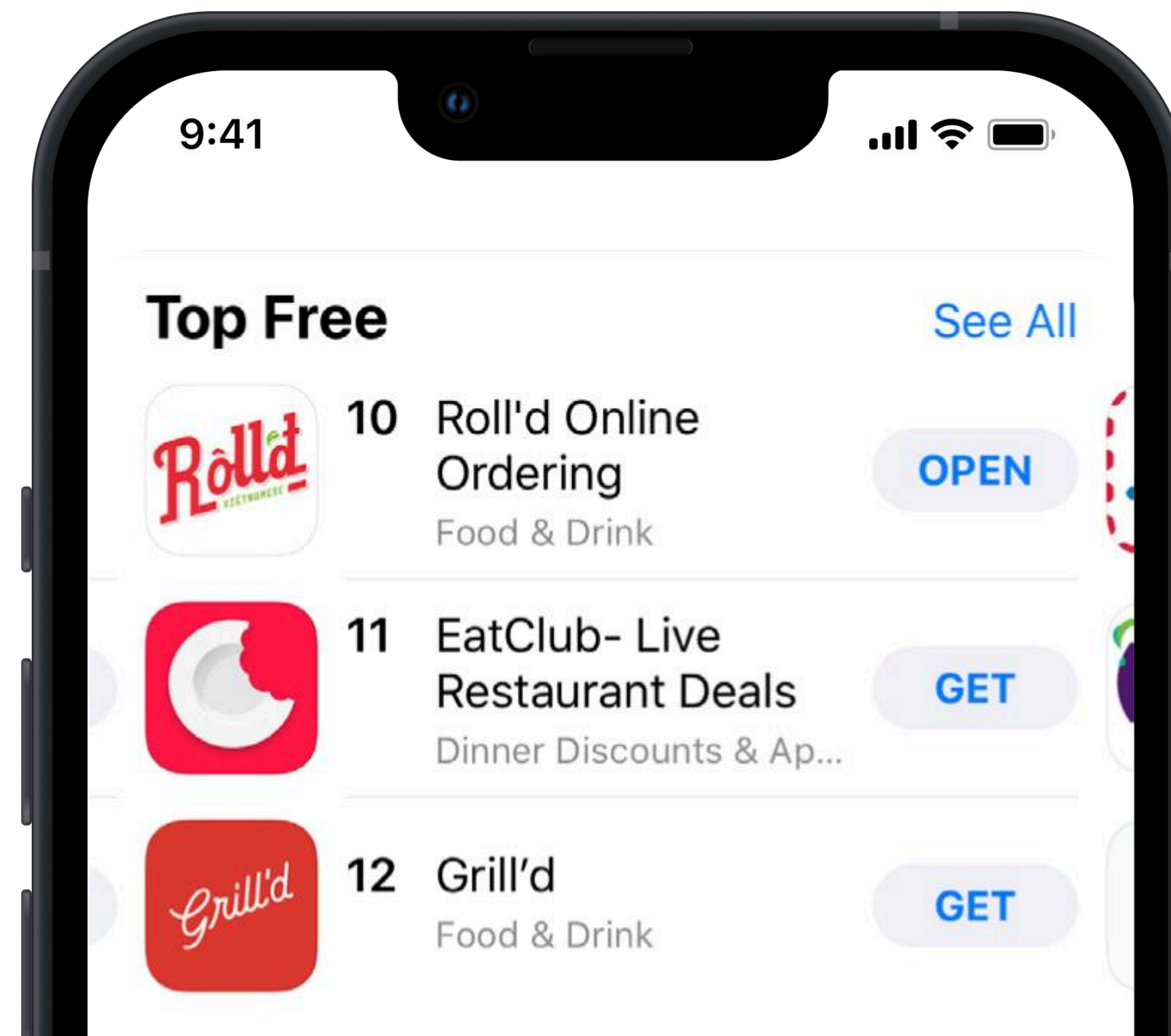
To make checking out faster, I employed Fitts's Law as a guiding principle to make sure critical actions were large and easy to reach.



To ensure seamless pick-ups, I used clear, large and readable typography — choosing colors with high contrast to clearly indicate order progress.

Product impact

- Wait times reduced by 14%
- The app drove 5% revenue increase
- Achieved #10 rank in Food & Drink
- Fastest food reordering flow in AUS





Thank you

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